photobooth 4u

Your booth, *no internet* needed.

The photobooth4u app for **Windows** and **Mac**. The same booth as the website, installed on your laptop: it takes, saves and prints photos with **no internet**, and guests get their photo by scanning a QR over the booth Wi-Fi. **Page 2 is a one-page quick start** for event day.

1

Install once

Windows 10 / 11 or macOS. Activate with your code (internet needed once).

2

Shoot offline

Designs, layouts, frames, guest screen, USB camera, silent printing and vouchers all work offline.

3

Share on Wi-Fi

Photos save on the laptop. Guests on the booth Wi-Fi scan the QR and save their photo.

★ Quick start (page 2)

01 Install the app

02 Activate this laptop

03 Camera

04 Printing

05 Guests' photos over Wi-Fi

06 Updating the app

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Which packages include the app?

- **Lifetime** (online + offline), **Laptop 6-Month Pass**, and the **Laptop Booth** per event when you ask for the offline app.
- One code can activate more than one laptop: each laptop uses one of the code's **device slots**.

★ EVENT DAY

Quick start

Do these in order. The app must be installed and activated already (pages 3 to 5).

1 Plug everything in

Laptop on its charger. Guest screen by HDMI, set to **Extend** (Windows: `Win + P` → Extend). Camera on a full or dummy battery. Printer on, paper loaded.

2 Start the booth Wi-Fi

Connect the laptop to a **pocket Wi-Fi router** or a **phone hotspot**, and have guests join the same one. It doesn't need internet: a router with no SIM works, and a phone hotspot works with mobile data turned off. Guests only need to reach the laptop. *(The laptop's own Windows "Mobile hotspot" won't turn on unless the laptop is already connected to a network, so don't rely on it. Macs can't host their own Wi-Fi at all.)*

3 Open photobooth4u

From the Start menu (Windows) or Applications (Mac). It opens straight into the booth.

4 Choose the camera

Setup → 5 Session → Camera. Windows: **Nikon / Canon camera over USB**. Mac: **DSLR / mirrorless over USB**, then pick the camera. Or a webcam / HDMI capture card.

5 Check Setup and Share & start

Design, name, layout as usual. In **Share & start**, check the **event name**, **Photos on this laptop** and **Guests' phones** (it shows the address guests use). Type the **booth Wi-Fi name and password** if guests don't know it.

6 Choose the printers

In **Photo Session** tap 🖶 **Print settings**, pick each paper size and its printer. Printing is built in: no Print Helper, no pop-up.

7 Test with your phone

Take one session. Join the booth Wi-Fi on your phone, scan the photo QR, tap **Save photo**. Print once.

8 Open the guest screen

In **Setup → 5 Session**, tap **Open guest screen**. You're ready.

Works with no internet

- All designs, layouts, your frames, stickers, filters, retakes, Lock booth
- Guest screen, USB camera, silent printing, **vouchers**

Needs the website (internet)

- GCash / Maya QR payments (vouchers work offline)
- Online gallery & Google Drive, My Events, tablet booths, the print station

01 · ONCE PER LAPTOP

Install the app

We send you the installer link. Pick the one for your laptop.

WINDOWS 10 / 11

1. **Run the installer**
   Double-click **photobooth4u Setup….exe**.
2. **"Windows protected your PC"**
   Click **More info → Run anyway**. (The app isn't signed with a paid certificate yet; this is normal.)
3. **Allow admin once**
   Click **Yes**. It lets guests' phones reach the laptop on the booth Wi-Fi.

MACOS

1. **Open the .dmg**
   Use the **arm64** file for Apple Silicon (M1–M4), **x64** for Intel. Drag **photobooth4u** into **Applications**.
2. **First open: right-click → Open**
   If macOS still refuses: System Settings → Privacy & Security → **Open Anyway**.
3. **Allow connections**
   When macOS asks to accept incoming network connections, click **Allow**. That's the guests' QR.

New version? The app tells you when one is out. Your activation, designs and photos stay. See **Updating the app** (page 7) and **Pop-ups** (page 8).

02 · ONCE PER LAPTOP

Activate this laptop

1. **Connect to the internet (just this once)**
   Any Wi-Fi or phone hotspot.
2. **Type your code**
   The app opens on **Activate this laptop**. Type your `PB-XXXX-XXXX-XXXX` code and tap **Activate**.
3. **Done**
   The booth opens. From now on it works with no internet. The licence is tied to **this laptop**, so copying the app to another one doesn't work: activate each laptop with your code.

No internet at all?

Tap **No internet? Activate without internet**. The app shows a **Machine ID** (`WIN-…` / `MAC-…`).

Send us your code and that Machine ID (e.g. by text from your phone). We send back an **activation key**.

Paste it in the box and tap **Activate**.

03 · CAMERA

Use your DSLR / mirrorless camera

Over USB the app presses the **real shutter**, so your camera's settings, focus and flash all work. Nothing extra to install.

WINDOWS

- **Nikon**, **Canon EOS** (DSLR, M and R) and **Sony Alpha**. Built into the app.
- Plug the camera straight into the laptop with a **data** USB cable, switch it on, and pick **Nikon / Canon / Sony camera over USB**. After that it reconnects by itself.
- **Canon:** close **EOS Utility**. Older models (60D, 70D, 600D, 7D…): Menu → **Live View shoot: Enable**. Newer: **Choose USB connection app** → **Photo Import / Remote Control**. Wi-Fi off.
- **Sony:** on the camera set **USB Connection** → **PC Remote** (MENU → Setup → USB) and close Imaging Edge. If it won't connect, use its webcam mode (USB Streaming) or an HDMI capture card.

MAC

- **Canon, Nikon, Sony, Fujifilm** and most others.
- Canon: **Photo Import / Remote Control** USB mode. Nikon: nothing to set.
- Quit **Photos**, **Image Capture** and **EOS Utility** if they open.
- Pick **DSLR / mirrorless over USB**, choose the camera, **Connect**.

For every camera

- Mode dial on **P, A/Av, S/Tv or M**; save as **JPEG** (or RAW + JPEG).
- SD card in the camera.
- **Auto power off**: disable. Use a **dummy battery** for long events.
- Webcams and HDMI capture cards work too (no flash).

Printing

1 Set up the printer once

Install its driver and do one test print from the laptop. In the printer's own preferences set the **paper size**, **borderless** and, for 2×6 strips, **cut**.

2 Choose a printer per paper size

In **Photo Session** → 🖶 **Print settings**, pick a printer for each size (e.g. 4R on one, 2×6 strips on another). The app remembers it.

3 Auto-print

Print once to test, then tick **Auto-print every session**. Prints go straight to the printer, no pop-up.

Good to know

- The **Print Helper** isn't needed: it's built into the app.
- Same printer for two sizes? Add it to the laptop **twice**, each with its own defaults and name.
- The paper sizes in your package appear in Print settings.

05 · SHARING WITHOUT INTERNET

Guests' photos over Wi-Fi

Every photo is saved on the laptop. The laptop also serves a small photo page on the booth Wi-Fi, so guests save their photo straight to their phone. Nothing is uploaded.

Guest joins the booth Wi-Fi → Scans their photo QR → Taps Save photo

1 One Wi-Fi for laptop and guests

A small pocket router at the booth (no SIM or internet needed), or a phone hotspot (mobile data can be off). Venue Wi-Fi works too, if guests' phones can join it. The laptop's own Windows "Mobile hotspot" needs the laptop to be connected to a network first, so use a router or phone hotspot instead.

2 Check Share & start

Guests' phones shows the address guests open, with a ✓. If it says the laptop isn't on a Wi-Fi network, connect it first.

3 Optional: Join Wi-Fi QR

Type the **Wi-Fi name and password** under **Booth Wi-Fi for guests**. Guests then see a **Join Wi-Fi** QR next to their photo QR: scan it first, then the photo QR.

4 Print the QR sign

Under **QR sign**, save the sign with the Wi-Fi and **All photos** QR codes and print it (A5 or bigger) for the booth table.

Photos on this laptop

Saved in `Pictures/photobooth4u/<event name>/`, one file per session.

Open photos folder and **Change folder** are in **Share & start**. Copy the folder to a USB drive or upload it for your client after the event.

Guests can't open the photo?

Their phone must be on the **same Wi-Fi** as the laptop (phones sometimes switch back to mobile data: turn data off, or join the Wi-Fi again). The guests' page works until the app is closed.

GUEST PAYMENTS OFFLINE

Vouchers

QR payments (GCash, Maya) need the internet. **Vouchers** work offline: set **Guest payment** to **Vouchers** in **Setup → 5 Session**, sell the printed codes at the table, and each code works once.

06 · NEW VERSIONS

Updating the app

When a new version is out, a bar appears at the top of the booth. It needs **internet**, so update **before the event** at home or on any Wi-Fi, never on event day. Your activation, designs and photos stay.

WINDOWS

1. **The bar says "Version … is ready"**
   The app downloads it by itself in the background. You can keep using the booth.
2. **Tap Restart now**
   Later is fine too: it then installs when you close the app.
3. **Click Yes when Windows asks**
   "Do you want to allow this app to make changes?" is normal. Click **Yes**.
4. **Done**
   The app closes and opens again by itself on the new version.

MACOS

1. **The bar says "Version … is out"**
   Tap **Download**. It shows the progress; keep using the booth meanwhile.
2. **A window opens by itself**
   The new version arrives in your **Downloads** folder as a disk image. **Show it again** reopens the window.
3. **Drag it into Applications**
   Drag **photobooth4u** onto **Applications** and choose **Replace**.
4. **Quit the app and open it again**
   The bar is gone and you're on the new version.

Laptop with no internet? It keeps working as it is. To update, connect it to any Wi-Fi or phone hotspot once, open the app, and the bar appears within a few hours (or straight away after you close and reopen the app).

07 · POP-UPS YOU MAY SEE

Pop-ups: what to click

The app isn't signed with a paid certificate yet, so Windows and macOS ask a few extra questions the first time. These are normal. Here is what to answer.

WINDOWS POP-UP	WHAT TO DO
"Windows protected your PC"	Click **More info**, then **Run anyway**. Seen when you first run the installer.
"Do you want to allow this app to make changes to your device?"	Click **Yes**. Seen when installing and updating. It lets guests' phones reach the laptop on the booth Wi-Fi.
Windows Defender Firewall asks to allow photobooth4u	Tick **Private networks** and click **Allow access**, so guests' phones can open their photo.

MAC POP-UP	WHAT TO DO
"photobooth4u can't be opened" / "Apple cannot check it"	Right-click the app and choose **Open**, then **Open** again. Or System Settings → Privacy & Security → **Open Anyway**.
"photobooth4u wants to use your confidential information stored in 'photobooth4u Safe Storage' in your keychain"	It's the app's own saved settings. Type your **Mac login password** and click **Always Allow** (it won't ask again). It may ask again after an update.
"Do you want the application to accept incoming network connections?"	Click **Allow**. That is what lets guests scan the QR and open their photo.
"An item named photobooth4u already exists"	Click **Replace** (while updating).

A pop-up that isn't here? Don't guess: take a photo or screenshot of it and message us (Facebook Messenger, **m.me/roktetnachi**). Never type your code or password into a window that appeared from a website or a message.

08 · YOUR LICENCE

Your licence

How long it works

- **Lifetime:** renews by itself whenever the laptop has internet. With no internet it keeps working for **75 days + 30 days' grace**, then asks to connect once.
- **6-Month Pass / per-event:** works until the code's end date, with or without internet.
- Changes we make for your code (print sizes, vouchers, retakes…) arrive when the app starts with internet, or tap **Check for changes** in Share & start.

New laptop or reinstalling?

- On the old laptop: **Share & start → Deactivate this laptop**. That frees its device slot.
- Activate the new laptop with the same code.
- Old laptop lost or broken? Message us and we free its slot.
- **Don't set the laptop's clock back:** the booth locks until the clock is right again.

09 · TROUBLESHOOTING

If something goes wrong

PROBLEM	TRY THIS
"Windows protected your PC" / Mac won't open it	Windows: **More info → Run anyway**. Mac: right-click the app → **Open**, or Privacy & Security → **Open Anyway**.
Activation says no free device slot	Deactivate an old laptop (Share & start), or message us to free one.
Camera not found (Windows)	Data USB cable straight into the laptop, camera on. Close EOS Utility / NX Studio and any "Import photos" window. Unplug, replug.
Canon: no live view	Menu → **Live View shoot: Enable**, close the menu, mode dial on P, Tv, Av or M.
Camera "couldn't focus"	Point it at something with detail, add light, or set the lens to **MF**.
Guests' QR doesn't open	Phone and laptop on the same Wi-Fi; phone's mobile data off. Mac: allow incoming connections (System Settings → Network → Firewall).
Prints show a pop-up or go to the wrong printer	Print settings → choose the printer for that size again.
"Connect to the internet to continue"	Lifetime check-in is due: connect once to any internet and reopen the app.
The booth is locked	The code ended, the laptop was removed, or the clock was changed. Check the date and time, then message us.

Need help? Message us.

We're on Facebook Messenger: **m.me/roktetnachi**

Message us